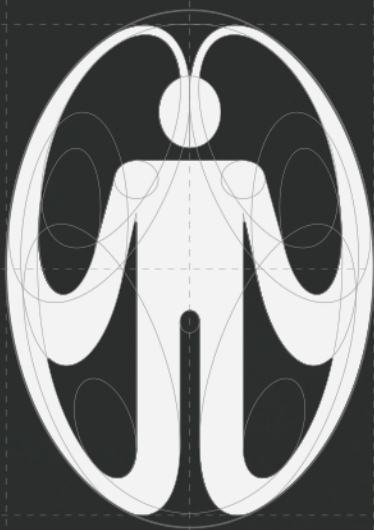




CTRL ONE BASIC OPERATION GUIDE
1ST EDITION
SERIAL No. 10001

HOW TO USE 8 INTERVENTIONS FOR
AN ATTENTION YOU NO LONGER
CONTROL

User manual

UFO

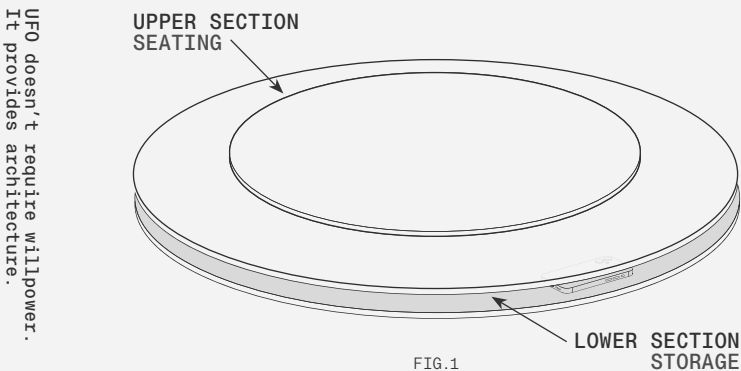
IMPERCEPTIBLE
PRESENCE IN THE
PERCEPTUAL FIELD

WHAT IT IS

UFO is a circular side table designed to do one thing: remove your phone from your line of sight without requiring you to make any difficult decisions to achieve it.

It's not a box where you lock your phone away. It's not a drawer you close. It's not an act of surrender or discipline. It's a piece of furniture that takes advantage of something you already do—leaving your phone wherever you can—and redirects that action to a place where the object disappears from view while still remaining present.

The phone is still there. It's just that it's not looking at you anymore.



WHY IT WORKS

In 2017, psychologist Adrian Ward demonstrated in a Harvard University study that the mere visible presence of a smartphone on a table reduces available cognitive capacity—even without interacting with it, and even with the screen off. The brain registers the object, assigns it relevance, and devotes attentional resources to not picking it up—which is exactly the same as picking it up, in terms of mental load.

The visual stimulus of the phone doesn't just cause distraction: it creates a constant tension between what



you're doing and what the device promises you. That tension is called residual cognitive load. And it's eliminated not by turning off the phone, but by removing it from your field of vision.

ANATOMY OF THE OBJECT

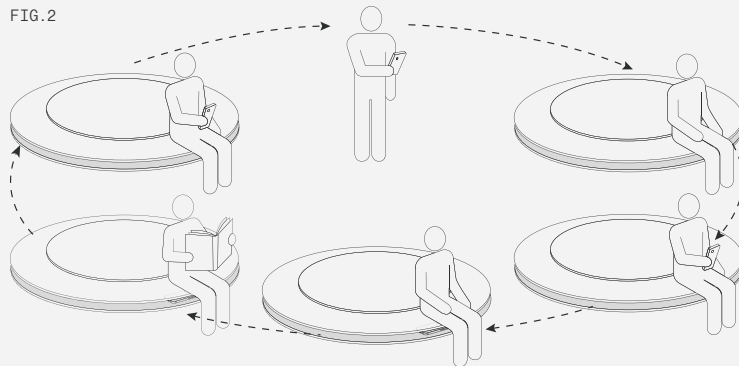
UFO has the shape of a flattened disc—hence its name. The circular rim around the edge serves as the seat: you can sit on it from any angle, with your back to the center. The central upper surface acts as a side table: you can place whatever you like on it.

On the underside, between the base and the tabletop, there is a dark perimeter slot that runs the entire circumference of the piece. That slot is the mechanism. It has no lid, no lock, no indicator. It is simply a shadowed recess, invisible from any normal viewing angle, capable of holding one or more devices.

The phone placed in that slot is physically present in the space but is visually inaccessible. You don't see it from above. You don't see it standing up. You don't see it from the couch. You know it exists—that's what matters—but it has ceased to function as a stimulus.

HOW TO USE IT

Using UFO requires no learning curve. It simply involves recognizing a gesture you already make. When you get home, when you sit down, when you start eating dinner or reading, there's a moment—usually unconscious—when you look for a place to put your phone. That's the gesture UFO picks up on.



STEP 1 APPROACH THE PIECE OF FURNITURE

Stand in front of any point on the circular ring. UFO has no fixed orientation: you can sit down from any angle.

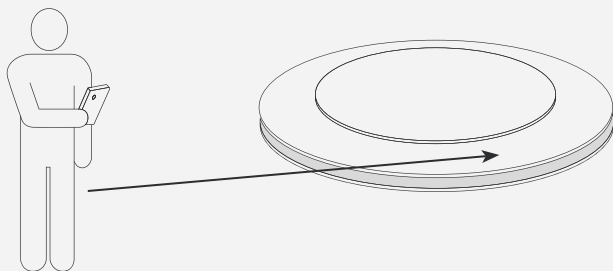


FIG.3

STEP 2 SIT ON THE HOOP

Rest your weight on the circular rim. The hoop serves as the seat. You'll be facing away from the center of the piece, with your legs pointing outward.

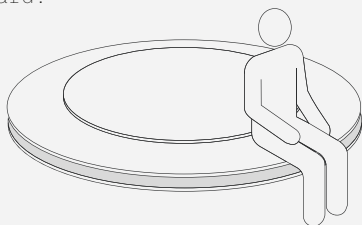


FIG.4

STEP 3 PLACE YOUR PHONE IN THE SLOT

You're holding your phone—just like always. With the same natural motion you'd use to set it between your legs or on a cushion, slide the device into the dark slot right beneath where you're sitting. No need to look. The slot runs all the way around the unit: the phone fits from any angle.

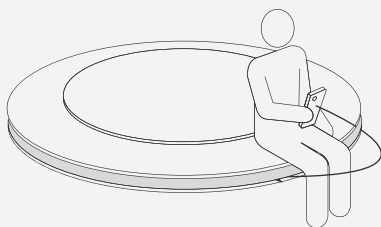


FIG.5



Don't turn it off. Don't activate any mode.
Don't make any decisions about the
phone. Just let it go there.

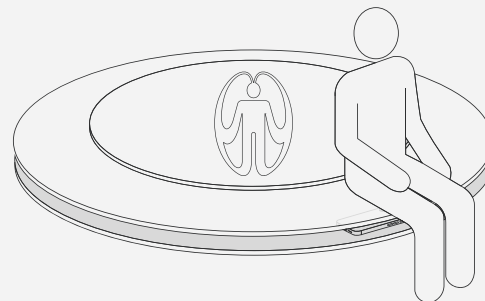


FIG.6

STEP 4 JUST DO WHAT YOU WERE GOING TO DO

Read. Relax. You don't have to manage any apps, timers, or focus modes. The environment has already changed. What you do from here on out is up to you.

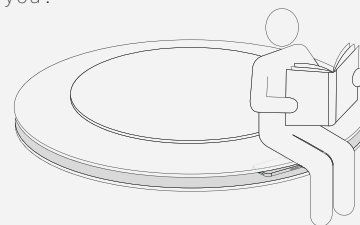


FIG.7

STEP 5 RETRIEVE YOUR PHONE WHEN YOU NEED IT

Reach into the slot and pull the device out. There's no mechanism, no friction involved. If you need it, it's right there.

The question UFO asks you at that moment (without actually asking it) is whether you really need it.

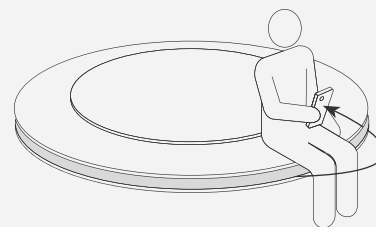


FIG.8

WHEN TO USE IT

UFO is designed for moments of temporary solitude: the time on the couch before dinner, a weekend afternoon with no specific plans, the downtime at home between tasks. These are precisely the moments when compulsive phone use is most likely to kick in—not because there’s a need, but because the device is in plain sight and the impulse faces no resistance.

It also works in shared spaces. When there are other people in the room, UFO can hold multiple devices at once. The unit doesn’t discriminate. And the social effect is a side benefit: if no one’s phone is visible, no one’s phone triggers the urge that makes the rest of them pick theirs up.

WHAT UFO DOESN’T DO

UFO doesn’t stop you from using your phone.

IT DOESN'T
BLOCK YOUR
APPS.

IT DOESN'T
TRACK YOUR
SCREEN
TIME.

IT DOESN'T
GUILT TRIP
YOU.

IT DOESN'T
JUDGE YOU.

UFO is a piece of furniture. It does what good furniture does: it blends into the background and makes things work better without you knowing exactly why.

The only intervention it offers is architectural: if the stimulus isn’t visible, the reflexive gesture has nowhere to latch on. What you do from there—whether you read, rest, or talk to someone—is up to you. UFO just clears the field.

CURRENT LIMITATION

UFO could be manufactured today. The material exists, the form exists, the slot exists. What is speculative is not the object itself but its premise: the idea that a piece of home furniture is designed specifically to manage a behavioral addiction belongs to a design paradigm that is not yet mainstream.



The first: it requires an initial voluntary action—placing the phone in the slot. Without that action, the piece is just a small table. The design does the work, but someone has to activate it.

The second is harder to solve: UFO eliminates the visual stimulus, but not the knowledge that the phone is there. For a deeply ingrained habit, knowing it exists thirty centimeters away may be enough to trigger the impulse. UFO operates on perception, not memory. In such cases, it works best when combined with other proposals in this manual.

Unidentified Furniture Object

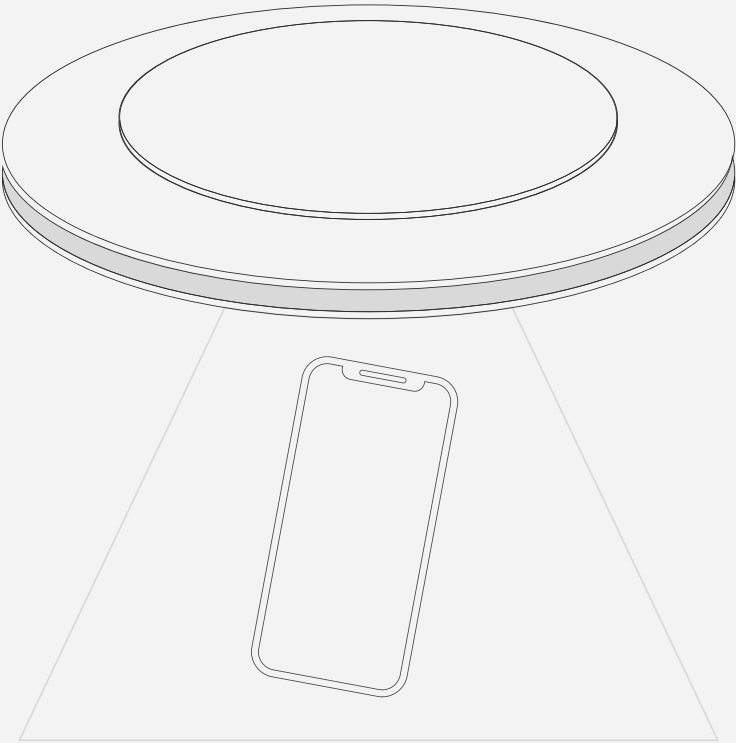


FIG.9